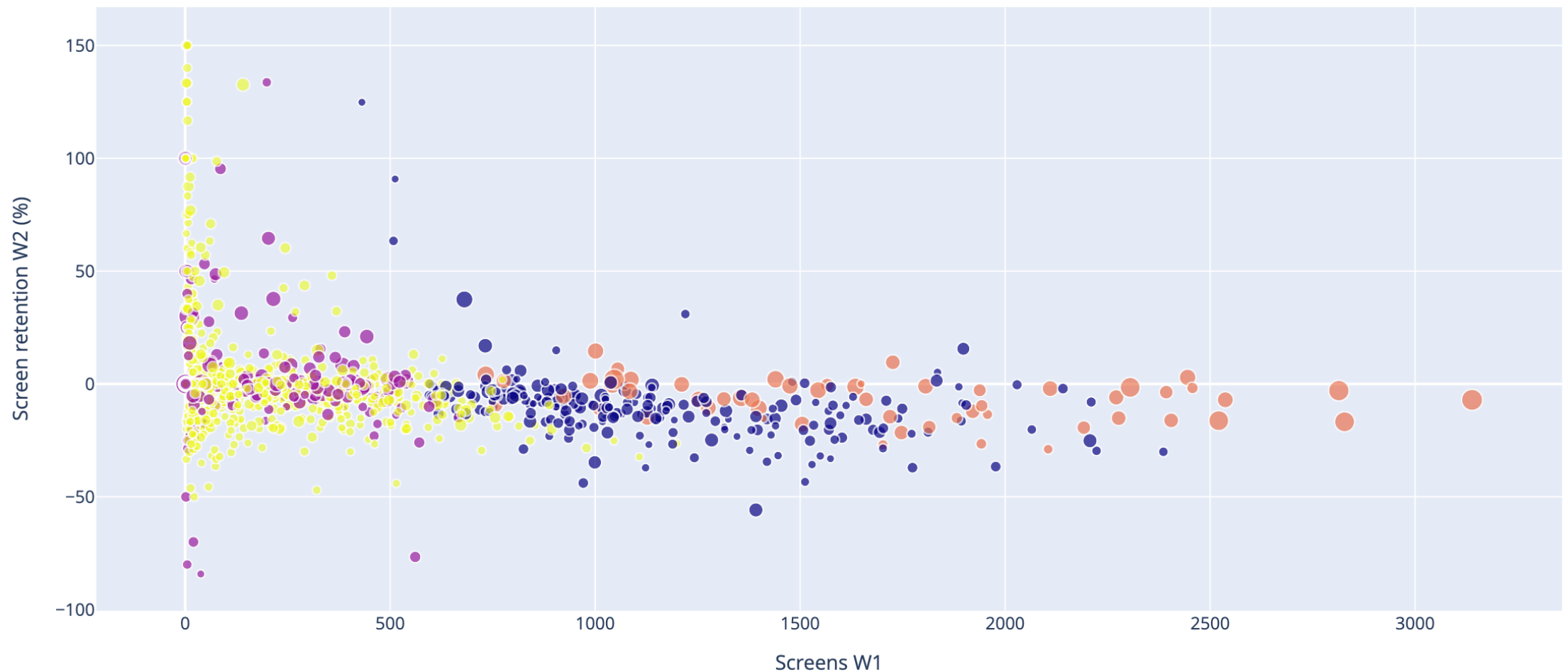


Four Major Release Categories in the Brazilian Theatrical Market



Blockbusters

These films open on an average of 1,689 screens, with an exceptional R\$29,285 revenue per screen in W1.

The important point is that these films naturally lose screens and revenue as their run progresses, but they decline much more slowly than other wide releases. By W4, they still retain roughly 65% of their initial screen count.

From week 1 to week 4, their average revenue per screen remains high: R\$29,285, R\$21,898, R\$16,033, R\$12,411.

Strong Holdovers

These films open on only 197 screens on average, yet generate R\$18,022 per screen.

They are highly efficient per screen despite opening on roughly one-sixth as many screens as Blockbusters.

Their theatrical footprint remains remarkably stable, averaging 197, 194, 183, and 156 screens in Weeks 1, 2, 3, and 4, respectively.

These films may not be designed for very wide distribution, but they successfully find their audience and give exhibitors relatively little reason to remove them from screens.

Standard Performers

These films perform well enough to justify a large national release, but not strongly enough to maintain their initial theatrical footprint for very long.

These films also receive substantial initial distribution (1138 screens on avg on Week 1), but their initial efficiency is almost half that of Blockbusters with only R\$15377 per screen. So their screen count declines quickly : -10%, -16%, -23% on weeks 2, 3 and 4.

Fast-Declining releases

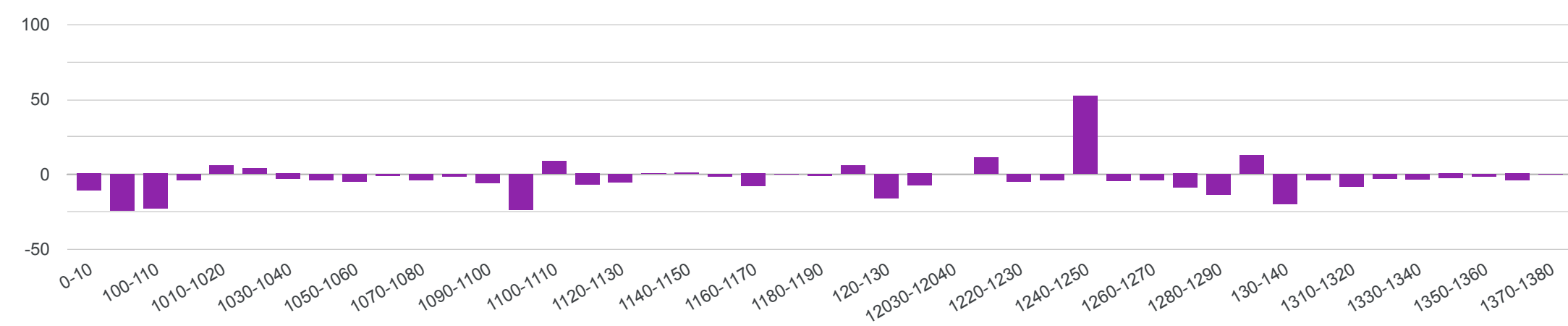
This is the profile of a limited release that fails to generate sufficient demand to maintain its theatrical footprint. By week 4, only about 36% of the initial screens remain.

This category represents 60% of the dataset.

Although their initial release size is very similar to that of Strong Holdovers, their trajectories quickly diverge, with lower revenue per screen and a rapid decline in the number of theaters.

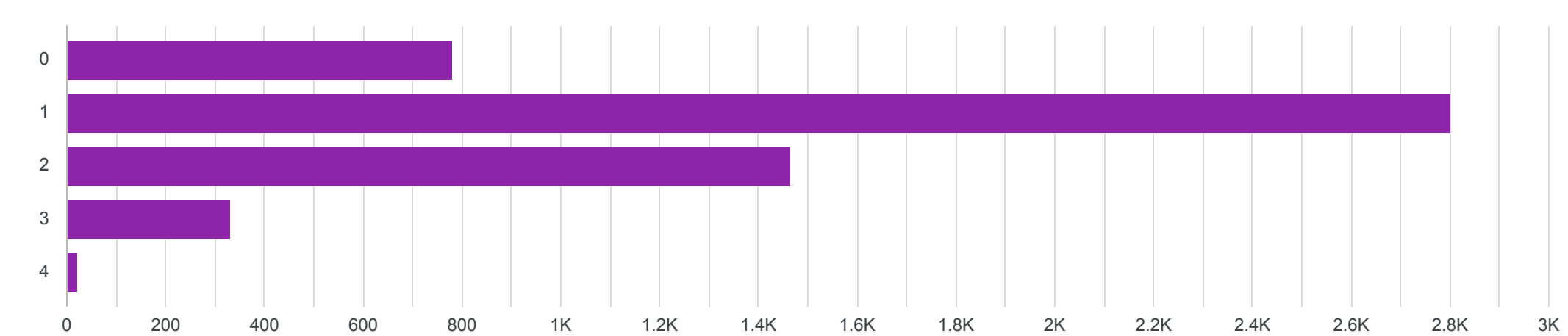
Screen Drop Is More Strongly Associated with New Major Releases than with Admissions or Revenue

W2 Screen Retention by W1 Admissions per Screen



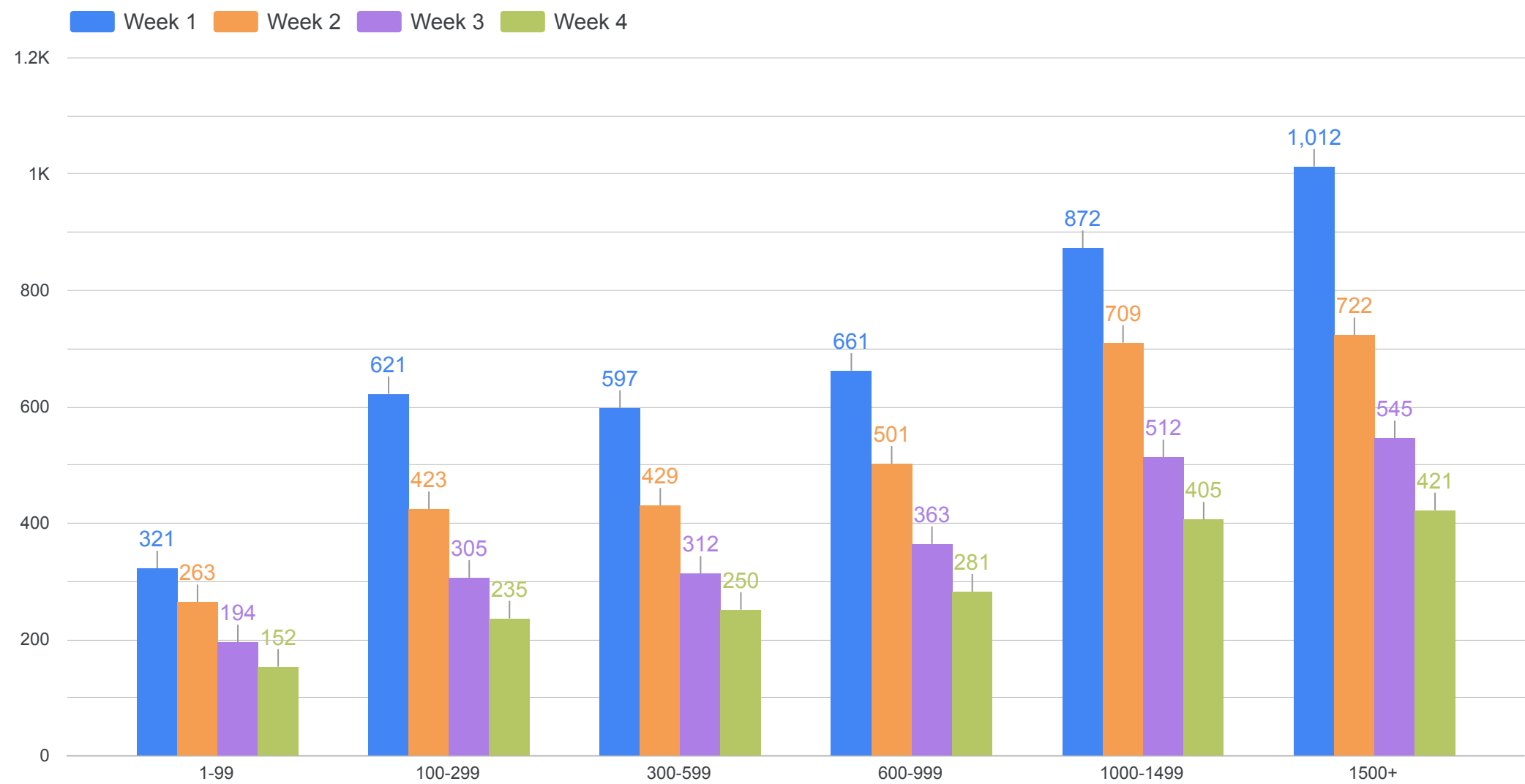
No clear relationship emerges between W1 admissions per screen and W2 screen retention. Higher W1 performance does not systematically result in stronger screen retention.

Screen Retention by Number of Major Releases in Week 2



A clearer relationship emerges between competitive pressure and screen retention. Films facing no new major release in W2 lose 9% of their screens on average, compared with 22% when facing four major releases.

The Widest Releases Also Deliver the Highest Admissions per Screen



Admissions per screen remain relatively stable between 100 and 999 opening screens, suggesting little dilution as distribution expands.

Above 1,000 screens, performance per screen increases sharply, with 1,500+ screen releases exceeding 1,000 admissions per screen in Week 1.

Rather than showing diminishing returns, the data suggests a strong selection effect: the widest releases are allocated to films with exceptionally high audience potential.

Key Takeaways for Theatrical Distribution

The analysis suggests that theatrical performance depends not only on a film's initial audience response, but also on its release strategy and competitive environment.

Four distinct theatrical trajectories emerge from the data, showing that films with similar opening sizes can evolve very differently.

Week 1 admissions per screen alone do not clearly predict W2 screen retention. Competitive pressure from new major releases appears more strongly associated with screen losses.

Finally, wider releases show no evidence of audience dilution: admissions per screen remain stable up to 1,000 screens and increase substantially for the widest releases.

Distribution decisions should therefore combine expected audience potential, release scale and upcoming competitive pressure rather than relying on opening-week performance alone.

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Data source: ANCINE — Brazilian Film and Audiovisual Observatory

<https://www.gov.br/ancine/pt-br/oca/publicacoes/mercado-audiovisual-brasileiro/cinema/arquivos.csv/listagem-de-filmes-brasileiros-lancados-1995-a-2025.csv>

<https://www.gov.br/ancine/pt-br/oca/publicacoes/mercado-audiovisual-brasileiro/cinema/arquivos.csv/listagem-de-filmes-brasileiros-e-estrangeiros-exibidos-informacoes-por-semana-2009-a-2025.csv>

Data preparation and analysis: Google BigQuery, Python, Pandas, Sklearn, Plotly